

DR. GAYANI RAJASEKHAR: TRANSFORMING YOUNG LIVES THROUGH EDUCATION

In an era dominated by the mighty rat race to pursue success, where the well-being of little children gets sacrificed under the weight of books and expectations, Dr. Gayani Rajasekhar, a doctor by profession and altruist by passion, opened a way for children with a pressure-free education of holistic approach and ethical input with the goal of reforming the present day's learning system. Her unique path as an educator goes beyond the rigid confines of textbooks and examinations and envision a space where education is not just a curriculum it's a way of life. She expresses that a school must identify each child's unique talents and nurture them through diverse activities.

To her, schooling is more than just the transmission of knowledge; it is a celebration of personality. The school, in collaboration with teachers and parents, finds and fosters each child's particular skills via a variety of activities. The school's curriculum includes an astounding assortment of 18 activities, ranging from sports like boxing, karate, and swimming to artistic outlets like dance, music, and ceramics, with a refreshing 60% concentration on sports and co-curriculars and 40% on academics.

Dr. Gayani Rajashekar, wise and firm in her ideas, has laid the groundwork for the virtues she instils in the school culture, which requires complete emphasis on one's intellect, body, and soul to achieve extraordinary life objectives.

With an impressive academic background, including an MBBS, MD, and post-doctoral program specializing in Intensive Care, Dr. Gayani initially worked as a resident doctor in Bengaluru. It was during this time that she encountered children with learning disabilities who would feign illness to avoid attending classes. This eye-opening experience inspired her to delve deeper into the complexities of a child's mind. Driven by her newfound passion, Dr. Gayani pursued a Masters in Psychology, specializing in child behaviour and development. She also obtained a Diploma in CIDTT (Cambridge International Diploma for Teachers and Trainers). What began as voluntary service in a family-owned residential school soon evolved into a wholehearted commitment to revolutionize education.

Fuelled by her innovative vision, Gayani.K initiated a transformative journey by founding a school in 2015. With an initial enrolment of 16 students, this institution has burgeoned into the most esteemed international school in Rayalaseema, boasting a thriving student body of 1500. She has been a mentor for more than 800 teaching staff over a decade. Moreover, the commitment to social responsibility shines through the school's laudable initiative of supporting a tribal school composed of rag-pickers, reflecting a profound dedication to uplifting underprivileged communities through education.

Married into a family entrenched in the education sector for over five decades, Gayani.K stands at the helm of an educational legacy catering to a staggering 18,000 students from kindergarten to Grade 12. Their unwavering commitment to education, coupled with a focus on technological integration and community service, showcases a legacy that transcends traditional boundaries, positively impacting lives and shaping futures.

In today's world, education has become a business a monetary gain takes precedence over a child's growth. Many young children are burdened by the pressure of academics and choosing set career paths. Instead Dr Gayani believes that schools must encourage students to choose their own path based on their aptitudes and passion. At her school, the day begins with a sports/ club activities hour, which has improved the students' attention spans and made them eager to come to school every day with a smile. The success of such innovative methods are evident in students' achievements in various field such as robotics, AI, creative writing and public speaking.

Dr. Gayani Rajasekhar passionately believes in the power of education to transform societies. Her ethos revolves around fostering a society where love and kindness, coupled with right education, can enact profound changes in the world. She epitomizes a harmonious blend of medical expertise, educational innovation, and a profound commitment to societal upliftment, leaving an indelible mark on the landscape of education.

She concludes by saying what truly matters Is having a passion for serving the society to make a difference and contribute through one's own action, be it a doctor or a teacher.